

TPM Academy

Customer: Expeditors **Source outline:** [outline.pdf](#) **Glossary & acronyms:** [GLOSSARY.md](#)

An 8-week immersive Technical Product Manager Academy preparing engineers, analysts, and associate PMs to operate as Technical Product Managers. Every week blends conceptual frameworks, hands-on AI-augmented practice, and heavily small-group collaboration that mirrors the real TPM job.

Delivery format

- **Length:** 8 weeks × 5 days × **7 instructional hours/day** (≈280 hours)
- **Daily cadence:** 7 hrs instruction, 1 hr lunch, two 15-minute breaks
- **Style:** Small-group oriented — breakouts, pair critiques, stakeholder simulations, and PRD review cycles
- **Tooling:** Reveal.js decks authored as Markdown under `week-XX/markdown/presentations/day-XX-*.md`, built to standalone `.html` by `npm run build`. Student-facing activity briefs are Markdown under `week-XX/markdown/labs/day-XX-*.md`, with a facilitator-only companion per day under `week-XX/markdown/facilitator/day-XX-*.md`. Authoring details: `course-tooling/tools/AUTHORING.md`.
- **Assessments:** Pre- and post-academy Product Management and Data Literacy assessments (administered on the Skills/SkillIQ platform)

Daily template

BLOCK	DURATION	FOCUS
Opening & objectives	0:15	Frame the day; connect to prior learning
Teaching Block 1 + Activity 1	1:15	Introduce concept → small-group application
Morning break	0:15	
Teaching Block 2 + Activity 2	1:15	Deepen concept → apply to group artifact
Lunch	1:00	
Teaching Block 3 + Activity 3	1:15	New angle → group critique or simulation
Afternoon break	0:15	
Teaching Block 4 + Activity 4 + Wrap	1:30	Integrate → readouts → reflection

Week-by-week topic map

WEEK	THEME	CAPSTONE CHECKPOINT
1	Customer-Centric Foundations	—
2	Strategic Design & Metrics	—
3	Requirements Engineering & Mini-Capstone	Non-AI PRD deliverable + peer review
4	Technical Architecture & Constraints	—
5	Technical Infrastructure & Modeling	—
6	Stakeholder Alignment & Negotiation	—
7	Agile Delivery & ADO Mastery	—
8	AI Spec Development & Capstone	Real-world capstone + artifact presentations

Pre-work (~3.5 hours, completed before Week 1)

- Exploring Product Management Philosophies and Frameworks
- Agile Methodologies primer
- Getting Started on Prompt Engineering with Generative AI
- Pre-assessment: Product Management
- Pre-assessment: Data Literacy

Repository layout

```
TPM/
├─ README.md
├─ Start.command / Start.bat
windows)
├─ course-tooling/
unless you're maintaining the pipeline
|   └─ package.json, package-lock.json
/ audit / convert / ui
|   └─ scripts/
build-html, build-pdf, preview)
|   └─ tools/
|       └─ AUTHORING.md
setup
|   └─ tpm.js
|   └─ build.js, pdf.js, ppt.js, ui.js, convert.js, audit.py
|   └─ coverage.json
input)
|   └─ theme.css
|   └─ template-reference.html
classes
|   └─ outline.pdf
(Expeditors)
├─ participant-setup/
setup
|   └─ markdown/
|       └─ presentations/TECH-SETUP.md
(source)
|   └─ TECHNICAL-REQUIREMENTS.md
├─ kickoff/
|   └─ markdown/
|       └─ presentations/kickoff.md
|       └─ labs/
packet
├─ instructor/
deck
|   └─ markdown/
|       └─ presentations/instructor.md
ground rules (source)
|   └─ assets/avatar.jpg
build time)
├─ capstone/
(same layout as week-XX)
|   └─ markdown/
|       └─ labs/README.md
summary
└─ week-XX/
    └─ markdown/
        └─ presentations/
            └─ day-XX-*.md
        └─ labs/
(spoiler-free)
|   └─ README.md
outcomes
|   └─ day-XX-*.md
steps, deliverable
|   └─ facilitator/
```

← this file (course overview)
← double-click launchers (mac / windows)
← all build tooling – never edit
← npm scripts: build / pdf / dev
← shell/cmd wrappers (setup, build-html, build-pdf, preview)
← underlying JS + Python
← authoring guide + GitHub-mirror
← unified CLI dispatcher
← underlying tools
← outline → file map (audit)
← shared deck theme
← visual reference for theme
← canonical course outline
← pre-academy tech
← participant-facing setup deck
← client-facing requirements doc
← half-day pre-Week-1 orientation
← kickoff deck (source)
← facilitator schedule + activity
← standalone instructor-intro
← about me, prereqs, pledge,
← instructor photo (inlined at ground rules)
← consolidated capstone reference
← Week-3 + Week-8 capstone
← one folder per week
← all sources for this week
← deck sources
← one deck per day
← STUDENT-facing activity briefs
← week schedule + learning
← activities: purpose, setup,
← FACILITATOR-only companion to

```

labs/
├── day-XX-*.md           ← cues, answer keys, timings,
reflections
├── assets/              ← per-week binaries (images,
└── diagrams/

```

After build, the `dist/` output (and public mirror) reorganizes for participant browsing:

```

<folder>/
├── presentations/      ← built outputs grouped by format
│   ├── reveal/        (HTML)
│   ├── pdf/           (PDF)
│   └── ppts/          (PowerPoint)
├── labs/              ← flattened out of source markdown/labs/ (student activities)
├── facilitator/       ← flattened out of source markdown/facilitator/ (facilitator
└── guides/            guides)
└── assets/

```

Other instructors get the source `markdown/` layout via the instructor mirror; participants get the flat `presentations/ / labs/ / assets/` layout via the public mirror.

How to run a deck

Each deck can be delivered in three formats — pick whichever fits the audience:

FORMAT	COMMAND	WHEN TO USE
Reveal.js HTML (default)	<code>npm run build</code>	Live presentation. Open <code>dist/<folder>/presentations/reveal/<name>.html</code> in any browser; press <code>S</code> for speaker notes/clock. Self-contained — works offline, no CDN.
PDF + PowerPoint	<code>npm run pdf</code>	Both render together in one pass. PDFs land in <code>dist/<folder>/presentations/pdf/<name>.pdf</code> , PPTs in <code>dist/<folder>/presentations/ppts/<name>.pptx</code> . Both incremental (skip unchanged). Add <code>-- --force</code> to re-render everything.
PowerPoint (one-off)	<code>npm run ppt -- <deck.md></code>	Single deck override when you don't need a full PDF rebuild. Output at <code>dist/<folder>/presentations/ppts/<name>.pptx</code> . Lossy — gradients, cards, multi-column layouts don't survive; content only. PDF is the better visual-fidelity hand-off.

First-time setup for a new instructor

Easiest path — double-click the launcher (no command-line typing):

PLATFORM	DOUBLE-CLICK
macOS	<code>Start.command</code> (Finder may ask to allow first run — right-click → Open)
Windows	<code>Start.bat</code>

A console window opens, runs first-time setup if needed (prereq check + `npm install`), then opens your browser to a build UI at `http://localhost:3000`. The UI has buttons for:

- **Build HTML decks** — all 43 to `dist/<folder>/presentations/reveal/`
- **Build PDF + PowerPoint** — incremental, with a Force button alongside

- **Live preview a deck** — pick from a dropdown, opens reveal-md at `localhost:1948`
- **Open the output folder** — opens `dist/` in Finder / Explorer
- **Curriculum coverage audit** — runs the audit script

Output streams live into the UI; close the console window when done.

Prerequisites the launcher checks for you: Node 18+, Python 3, pandoc. If any are missing it prints the exact install command for your OS.

If you prefer the command line:

```
# macOS / Linux
git clone https://github.com/kiddcorplp/Expeditors_TPM_instructor.git
cd Expeditors_TPM_instructor
./course-tooling/scripts/setup           # checks prerequisites, installs npm deps
./course-tooling/scripts/preview         # live preview at http://localhost:1948
./course-tooling/scripts/build-html      # all HTML decks
./course-tooling/scripts/build-pdf       # all PDFs + PPTs
```

```
REM Windows
git clone https://github.com/kiddcorplp/Expeditors_TPM_instructor.git
cd Expeditors_TPM_instructor
course-tooling\scripts\setup.cmd
course-tooling\scripts\preview.cmd
course-tooling\scripts\build-html.cmd
course-tooling\scripts\build-pdf.cmd
```

If you prefer the underlying npm scripts:

```
# Prerequisites: Node 18+, Python 3 (for audit), pandoc (for PPT)
npm install                                # one time
npm run build                             # all HTML decks
npm run pdf                               # all PDFs + PPTs
    (incremental, add -- --force to rebuild)
npm run dev                               # live preview
npm run audit                             # curriculum
    coverage check
```

Detailed setup walkthrough and per-tool install commands: `course-tooling/tools/AUTHORING.md` .

CI behavior

The HTML build runs in CI on every push to `main` . PDFs and PPTs render together in CI on manual workflow dispatch — they're produced in the same pass. PPTs are skipped if you don't have `pandoc` installed locally (PDF-only still works via the bundled Chromium).

One-deck PPT override

```
npm run ppt -- week-01/markdown/presentations/day-01-ai-fundamentals-prompting.md
```

Current build status

- ✓ Week 1 — Customer-Centric Foundations
- ✓ Week 2 — Strategic Design & Metrics

- ✓ Week 3 — Requirements Engineering & Mini-Capstone
- ✓ Week 4 — Technical Architecture & Constraints
- ✓ Week 5 — Technical Infrastructure & Modeling
- ✓ Week 6 — Stakeholder Alignment & Negotiation
- ✓ Week 7 — Agile Delivery & ADO Mastery
- ✓ Week 8 — AI Spec Development & Capstone